

Abdullah Al Zahid

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September 30, 2026

Heather Thompson

Human Resources

Parks & Recreation, City of Toronto

Re: Project Manager Business Transformation (Job ID 64483)

Dear Heather Thompson,

I would like to apply for the Project Manager Business Transformation position with the CPDD Transformation Unit. I am an Assistant Planner with the City and part way through a computer science degree, and the part of this role I am most drawn to is using automation to reduce manual workloads.

That is work I have done in two organizations. At Metrolinx, scenario requests were being run case by case, so I set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and produced summaries of speed profiles and run-time variance that had been put together by hand. At the City I built the Transportation Data Dashboard, replacing a report rebuilt each quarter with one validated source the division reports from. In each case the harder part was not the code but getting the people who relied on the output to trust it and change how they worked, which is the people side of adoption the posting describes.

I also coordinate with divisions, consultants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and I write the briefing notes, memos and presentations that carry findings and recommendations to management. Working inside the City gives me a practical sense of how a change has to move through a division before it sticks.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have not led an enterprise-wide transformation, I am not trained in Prosci or Lean Six Sigma and hold no change management accreditation, and I have not led staff, administered a project budget or designed training programmes. I have not used Power BI, Tableau or VBA. I am applying because automation and adoption are the parts of this work I have actually done, and because the Qualified List covers permanent and temporary positions.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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